

Executive Briefing Document

Meeting: Watching the 2024 ICC Women's T20 World Cup

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The 2024 ICC Women's T20 World Cup is a premier international cricket tournament scheduled from 3 to 20 October 2024, with warm-up matches occurring between 28 September and 1 October 2024. Originally slated to be hosted by Bangladesh, the event has been relocated to the United Arab Emirates (UAE) due to political unrest in the original host country. The primary venues for the tournament are the Dubai International Cricket Stadium and the Sharjah Cricket Stadium, both located in the UAE.

The tournament features 10 top global women's cricket teams divided into two groups. The competition format includes group stage matches followed by knockout rounds, culminating in semi-finals and the final match. Matches are scheduled throughout the day, requiring careful consideration of timing and logistics for viewing. The ICC administers the event, which continues the biennial tradition of the Women's T20 World Cup, offering significant prize money and attracting global attention.

2. KEY ATTENDEE BACKGROUND

- **Primary Stakeholders:**

- Cricket enthusiasts and executives involved in women's cricket development and promotion.
- ICC officials and representatives overseeing tournament operations and strategic planning.
- Media and broadcasting partners responsible for coverage and viewership engagement.
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Sponsors and commercial partners invested in the tournament's visibility and brand association.

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Stakeholder Interests:

- Ensuring smooth execution of the tournament despite venue changes.
- Maximizing global viewership and fan engagement through strategic scheduling and marketing.
- Leveraging the event to promote women's cricket and enhance its global profile.
- Monitoring logistical challenges due to venue relocation and match scheduling.

3. DETAILED DEVELOPMENTS & FINDINGS

- **Tournament Schedule:**

- Dates: 3-20 October 2024 (main tournament)
- Warm-up Matches: 28 September - 1 October 2024
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Matches are distributed throughout the day to accommodate all fixtures.

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Venue Details:

- Dubai International Cricket Stadium, Dubai, UAE
- Sharjah Cricket Stadium, Sharjah, UAE
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Both venues are internationally recognized cricket grounds with facilities to host high-profile matches.

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Tournament Format:

- 10 teams divided into two groups (Group A and Group B)
- Group stage matches determine progression to knockout rounds
- Knockout rounds include semi-finals and the final match
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The format maintains the biennial tradition of the ICC Women's T20 World Cup.

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Relocation Context:

- Originally to be hosted by Bangladesh
- Relocated to UAE due to political unrest in Bangladesh
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The shift necessitates adjustments in logistics, travel, and local arrangements.

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Competitive Landscape:

- Features top global women's cricket teams, enhancing competitive quality and viewer interest
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Significant prize money underscores the tournament's importance and prestige

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Administrative Oversight:

- Administered by the International Cricket Council (ICC), ensuring adherence to international standards and regulations.

4. IN-DEPTH DISCUSSION POINTS

- **Impact of Venue Relocation:**

- How the move from Bangladesh to UAE affects team preparations, fan attendance, and local engagement.

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Logistical challenges for teams, officials, and broadcasters adapting to new venues and schedules.

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Scheduling and Viewing Strategy:

- Analysis of match timings throughout the day to optimize live viewing and broadcast reach across different time zones.

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Consideration of personal availability and calendar conflicts during the tournament period (28 September - 20 October 2024).

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Tournament Format and Competitive Dynamics:

- Strategic implications of the two-group format on team progression and knockout matchups.

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Potential impact on team strategies given the condensed schedule and high stakes of knockout rounds.

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Promotion and Growth of Women's Cricket:

- Leveraging the tournament's global platform to enhance visibility and support for women's cricket.

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Role of prize money and ICC administration in elevating the sport's professionalism and appeal.

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Stakeholder Engagement:

- Opportunities for sponsors and media partners to maximize brand exposure and audience engagement given the tournament's global reach.

- Coordination between ICC, venues, and broadcasters to ensure seamless event execution.

5. CRITICAL QUESTIONS

- What are the specific logistical adjustments required due to the venue relocation from Bangladesh to UAE?
- How will match timings throughout the day affect viewership patterns across different regions?
- What are the key considerations for scheduling personal availability to watch matches live or via broadcast?
- How does the two-group format influence competitive strategies and potential outcomes?
- What measures are in place to ensure the safety and comfort of players and officials in the UAE venues?
- How can the tournament be leveraged to further promote women's cricket globally?
- What are the implications of the prize money structure on team motivation and tournament prestige?
- How will stakeholders coordinate to manage the transition and maximize the event's success?

6. ACTION ITEMS

- **Review Detailed Match Schedule:**

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Obtain and analyze the full match timetable, including warm-up matches, to plan viewing and engagement.

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- **Coordinate Logistics for Venue Relocation:**

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Assess travel, accommodation, and operational arrangements in Dubai and Sharjah to ensure readiness.

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- **Engage with ICC and Venue Officials:**

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Confirm venue facilities, safety protocols, and broadcasting capabilities.

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- **Plan Viewing Strategy:**

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Align personal and organizational calendars with match timings for optimal live viewing or broadcast access.

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- **Develop Stakeholder Communication Plan:**

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Prepare updates and briefing materials for sponsors, media partners, and internal teams regarding tournament developments.

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- **Monitor Political and Security Updates:**

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Stay informed on any changes in the geopolitical landscape that could affect the tournament's execution.

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- **Leverage Marketing and Promotion Opportunities:**

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Identify avenues to promote women's cricket and capitalize on the tournament's visibility.

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- **Prepare Post-Tournament Review Framework:**

- Establish criteria and processes for evaluating tournament outcomes, stakeholder satisfaction, and lessons learned.

This document consolidates all relevant facts and context for the upcoming 2024 ICC Women's T20 World Cup viewing and associated strategic considerations. It is designed to support informed decision-making and effective engagement with the event.